

STEADY PRESS

# Neck & Shoulder Pain Tracker

A 30-day record of where it hurts, what set it off, and what actually helped — so your next appointment starts with facts instead of guesswork.

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## How to use this journal

## THE ROUTINE

- Rate pain on the same 0–10 scale every time. The absolute number matters far less than the direction it moves over weeks.

NO PAIN 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 WORST IMAGINABLE

1 Noticeable, easy to ignore      3 Annoying, does not stop you      5 Hard to concentrate through      7 Limits what you can do

9 Unable to function

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

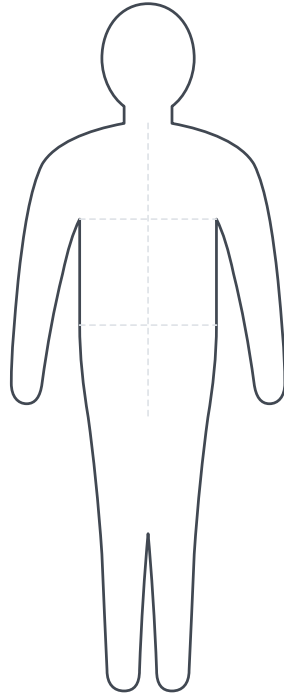
## BASELINE

# Where it hurts

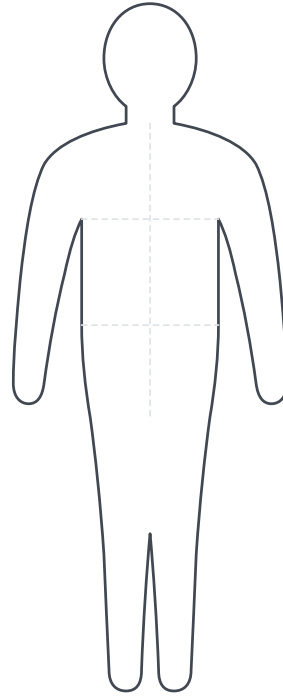
Do this on day one, then again every two weeks. Comparing two maps a month apart is often the clearest evidence you have.

DATE

OVERALL LEVEL TODAY (0–10)



FRONT



BACK

**MARKING KEY** write the letter on the spot that hurts

**A** Aching / dull    **S** Sharp / stabbing    **B** Burning    **T** Tingling / numb    **R** Radiating (draw an arrow)    **St** Stiff / restricted

**DESCRIBE IT IN YOUR OWN WORDS**

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# Daily log

Print one per day.

|      |             |                 |         |
|------|-------------|-----------------|---------|
| DATE | HOURS SLEPT | WOKE UP RESTED? | WEATHER |
|      |             |                 |         |

PAIN ON WAKING

|      |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |       |
|------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|-------|
| 0    | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10    |
| NONE |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | WORST |

PAIN AT BEDTIME

|      |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |       |
|------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|-------|
| 0    | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10    |
| NONE |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   | WORST |

THROUGH THE DAY

| TIME | WHAT I WAS DOING | 0-10 | NOTE |
|------|------------------|------|------|
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |
|      |                  |      |      |

SYMPTOMS TODAY

|                                                      |                                                 |                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Stiffness on waking         | <input type="checkbox"/> Pain turning head left | <input type="checkbox"/> Pain turning head right |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Headache from base of skull | <input type="checkbox"/> Shoulder blade ache    | <input type="checkbox"/> Tingling in arm or hand |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Jaw or temple tension       | <input type="checkbox"/> Clicking or grinding   | <input type="checkbox"/> Dizziness               |

ANYTHING ELSE

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# Trigger tracker

Tick what you did, then rate the pain that followed. Four weeks of this usually names the culprit.

SUSPECTED TRIGGERS

| DATE | TRIGGER | HOW LONG | PAIN AFTER (0-10) | CERTAIN? |
|------|---------|----------|-------------------|----------|
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |
|      |         |          |                   |          |

USUAL SUSPECTS TO WATCH

- ☐ Desk / laptop session
- ☐ Driving
- ☐ Phone or tablet use
- ☐ Sleep position
- ☐ Stress or deadline
- ☐ Carrying a bag on one side
- ☐ Workout or lifting
- ☐ Cold or draught
- ☐ Long day standing

OVERVIEW

30-day pain grid

One box per day. Shade lightly for a good day, heavily for a bad one, and write the number in the corner.

MONTH

YEAR

DAY OF MONTH

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 |
| 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 |
| 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 |

SHADING KEY

—

0–2 · good day

/

3–4 · manageable

x

5–6 · difficult

#

7–10 · flare

FLARE DAYS — WHAT HAPPENED

| DAY | WHAT HAPPENED | WHAT HELPED |
|-----|---------------|-------------|
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |
|     |               |             |

WHAT WORKS

# Relief log

The point of this page is to stop repeating things that never worked.

TRIED AND RATED

| DATE | WHAT I TRIED | HOW LONG | PAIN BEFORE | PAIN AFTER | AGAIN? |
|------|--------------|----------|-------------|------------|--------|
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |
|      |              |          |             |            |        |

THINGS WORTH TESTING

- ☐ Heat pack, 15 min
- ☐ Doorway chest stretch
- ☐ Different pillow
- ☐ Ice, 10 min
- ☐ Walk, 20 min
- ☐ Massage
- ☐ Chin tucks
- ☐ Screen at eye level
- ☐ Prescribed exercises

TREATMENT

Medication & treatment log

Keep one honest record. Doctors ask this question and almost nobody can answer it accurately.

MEDICATION

| DATE | WHAT | DOSE | TIME | DID IT HELP? |
|------|------|------|------|--------------|
|      |      |      |      |              |
|      |      |      |      |              |
|      |      |      |      |              |
|      |      |      |      |              |
|      |      |      |      |              |
|      |      |      |      |              |

APPOINTMENTS & THERAPY

| DATE | WHO I SAW | WHAT WAS DONE | COST |
|------|-----------|---------------|------|
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |
|      |           |               |      |



EVERY SUNDAY

# Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

## THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

| DAY | AVG PAIN | SLEEP | NOTABLE |
|-----|----------|-------|---------|
|-----|----------|-------|---------|

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## WHAT MADE IT BETTER

## WHAT MADE IT WORSE

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## ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

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APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

|               |        |
|---------------|--------|
| DATE OF VISIT | SEEING |
|               |        |

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

|          |             |
|----------|-------------|
| QUESTION | YOUR ANSWER |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |
|          |             |

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

|                                     |                                      |                                       |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Rest       | <input type="checkbox"/> Heat        | <input type="checkbox"/> Ice          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Stretching | <input type="checkbox"/> Painkillers | <input type="checkbox"/> Physio       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Massage    | <input type="checkbox"/> New pillow  | <input type="checkbox"/> Desk changes |

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

FREE SPACE

## Notes

Anything the structured pages did not capture.

## Before you start

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These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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